

# A community-run live bus tracker for your route

What it is, exactly what it records, what it structurally cannot do, and what we are asking of you.

PREPARED BY THE VOLUNTEER WHO MAINTAINS IT

**This tool is not affiliated with, operated by, or endorsed by Wonderful Transport. It was built by a commuter, it runs on a personal account, and it says all of this on its own front page and inside its privacy panel. The route name is used only so riders can tell which buses it tracks. Nothing in this document claims otherwise, and nothing in the tool does either.**

## 1 · WHAT IT IS

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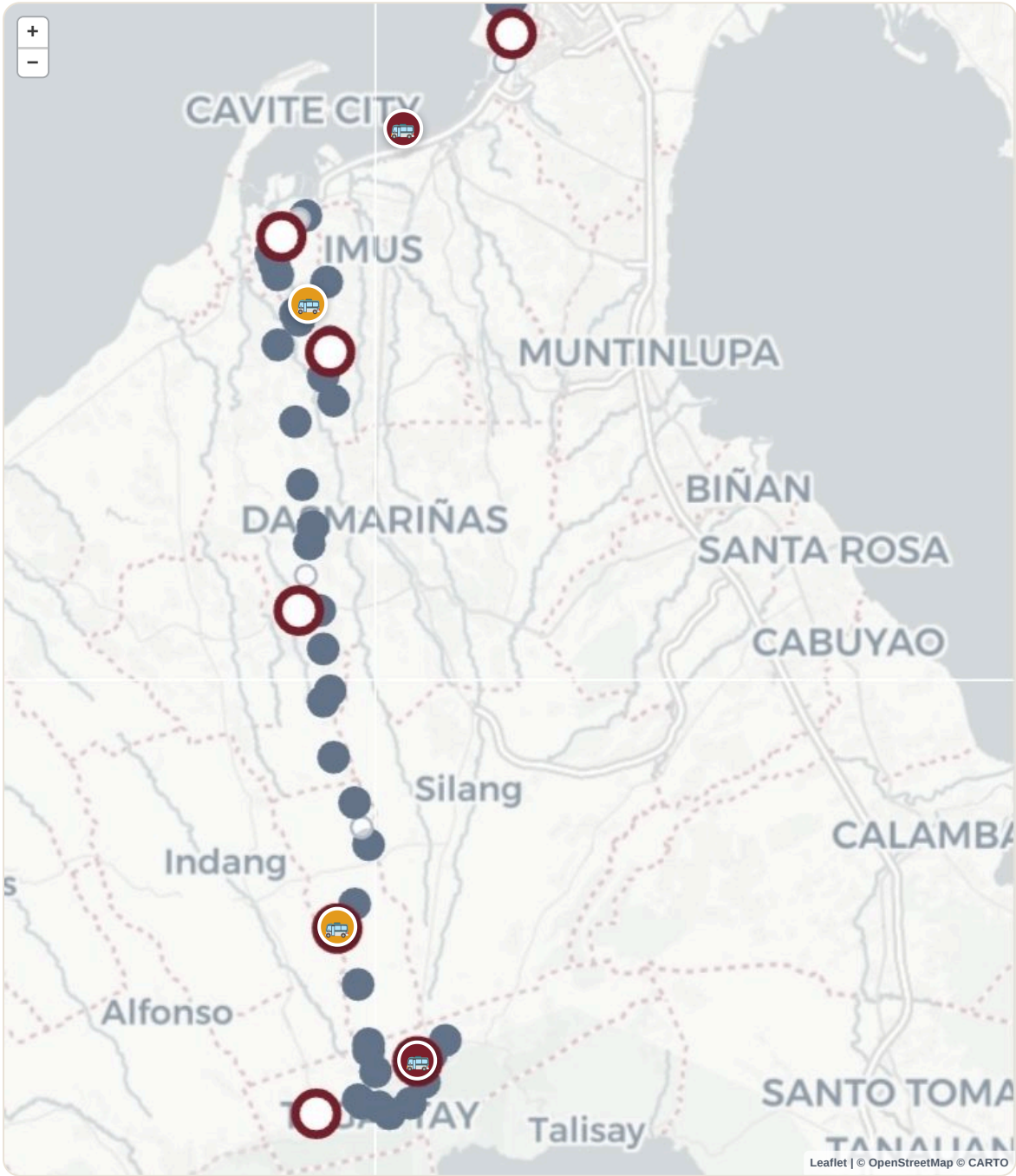
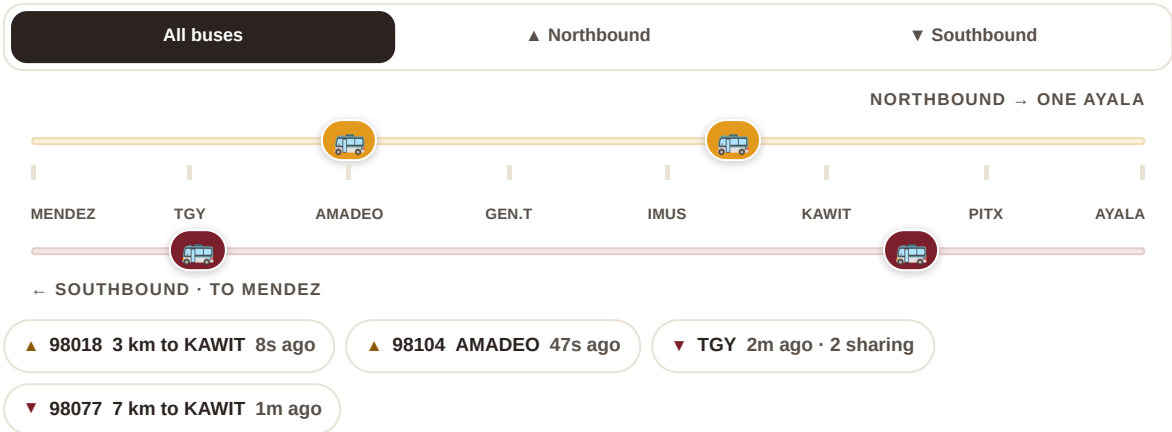
Commuters on this corridor currently find out where the bus is by asking in a Messenger group chat. This is the same question answered on a map. Anyone on board — a rider, a conductor, a driver — can tap a button to put their bus's position on a shared map for the length of that one trip. Everyone else can open a link and see it. There is no app to install and no account to create.

It covers one route: Mendez / Tagaytay to One Ayala, in both directions, using the checkpoints and stops from your own posted material.

What a rider sees when four buses are sharing. Example screen.

# 4 BUSES LIVE

Northbound between Imus and Kawit · updated 8s ago · trips every 30 mins



2 · WHAT IT RECORDS, AND WHAT IT CANNOT DO

This is the section we would want to read first in your position, so it comes before anything we are asking for.

There is no location history. Anywhere.

The database holds **one row per bus that is sharing right now**. Each position update **overwrites** the previous one. There is no trail table, no archive, and no backup of one — the schema has nowhere to put it. When the person on board taps Stop or closes the page, the row is deleted and the bus disappears from every map.

The consequence, stated plainly: **this tool cannot be used to review any driver's speed, breaks, route deviation, or working hours** — not because we promise not to, but because the data required to do it is never written down. Nobody can produce it later: not us, not you, and not anyone who compels us. It does not exist.

| WHAT IS STORED                                                                                                                               | FOR HOW LONG                                                                                              | WHAT IT IS NOT                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Current position</b> of a bus that is actively sharing: coordinates, direction, the bus number if one was typed, and a random session ID. | Overwritten every few seconds. Deleted on Stop, on closing the page, or automatically once it goes stale. | No name, no phone number, no account, nothing identifying the person. No previous position is retained. |
| <b>Count of devices</b> currently watching the map.                                                                                          | A random per-tab ID, deleted three minutes after the tab closes.                                          | A live gauge, not a log. No daily totals, no peaks, no history of who watched or when.                  |
| <b>Text sightings</b> — "northbound at Amadeo" — for when nobody is sharing GPS.                                                             | Deleted automatically after a couple of hours.                                                            | Posted with no name attached.                                                                           |
| <b>Route settings:</b> operating hours, headway, a pinned notice.                                                                            | Until an organiser changes them.                                                                          | Not personal data of any kind.                                                                          |

The direction check never leaves the phone

The app warns someone who picked the wrong direction by tracking how far along the route their bus has travelled. That calculation happens **in the sharing phone's own memory**, is never transmitted or stored, and is discarded when the tab closes. It exists to stop commuters being told a bus is coming when it is going away.

## **Sharing is voluntary, per trip, and stops on its own**

Nobody is tracked without acting. A person taps a button, picks a direction, and can stop at any moment. The app also stops by itself: it asks "still on the bus?" after twenty minutes without movement, and ends the session on its own once the bus has been parked at its destination. Closing the browser tab ends it too.

### 3 · WHO CAN DO WHAT

Three separate credentials, deliberately not interchangeable. All reads and writes go through server-side functions; the underlying tables are not directly reachable.

| CREDENTIAL                     | WHO HOLDS IT                       | WHAT IT ALLOWS                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Route name</b><br>public    | Anyone                             | Watching the map. Open to everybody, no key needed.                                                                    |
| <b>Sharing key</b><br>secret   | Posted in the community group chat | Putting a bus on the map. Can be rotated at any time, which cuts off everyone using the old one.                       |
| <b>Organiser key</b><br>secret | The volunteer maintainer only      | Operating hours, a pinned notice, removing a bad sighting, stopping a particular sharer, and rotating the sharing key. |

If a bus is being shared by someone who should not be, an organiser can stop that session, and rotating the sharing key ends all sharing until the new key is distributed. **That switch can be handed to you.**

### 4 · WHAT WE ARE ASKING

Three things, in order. The first needs nothing from you but a reply.

#### 1 Tell us if you want it changed or gone.

This is the whole reason for the letter. If anything here concerns you — the route name, the colours, the fact it exists — say so and we will change it or switch it off. The tool has one maintainer and no commercial interest in continuing against your wishes.

**Needed from you: a reply. Nothing else.**

#### 2 Let it be posted where riders will see it, and let crew mention it.

A tracker nobody knows about helps nobody. Permission to put a flyer at Mendez Crossing, Olivarez Terminal and One Ayala, and for conductors to point at it when asked "anong oras ang susunod?", would do more for it than anything else — and it reduces the number of people asking your staff that question.

**Needed from you: permission. No cost, no system to integrate.**

### 3 Work with us, at whatever depth suits you.

Options, from smallest to largest — take any, all, or none:

- **Your schedule, kept current.**

The app shows operating hours and headway. Right now those come from your posted material, which states it may change without notice. Told directly, we would update them the same day and riders would stop relying on a stale poster.

- **Crew sharing during trips.**

A conductor with a mounted phone produces far better coverage than an occasional volunteer rider. Same button, same limits described above.

- **Take it over entirely.**

The tool is free and open source under a licence that lets you run your own copy. We will hand over the route, the keys and the setup, and step back — or shut ours down so there is only one.

Needed from you: a conversation.

## 5 · WHAT IT COSTS YOU

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**Nothing.** There is no invoice attached to any of the options above and there will not be one later. The tool runs on free hosting tiers, is maintained by one volunteer commuter in their own time, carries no advertising, sells nothing, and has no analytics beyond the live count of open tabs described in section 2. The source code is public, so any claim in this document can be checked rather than taken on trust.

## 6 · WHAT IT DOES NOT DO WELL

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**Stated here so nobody discovers it later.**

- **It is only as good as its volunteers.** When nobody on board is sharing, the map is empty. An empty map does not mean there is no bus, and the app says so.
- **It is not an official schedule** and never claims to be. Positions come from passengers' phones, not from dispatch or vehicle hardware.
- **A phone must stay awake to share.** Mobile browsers suspend GPS when the screen locks, so a session ends when someone pockets their phone. A mounted phone on a charger is the practical answer.
- **It cannot tell your bus from another vehicle** travelling the same road. The bus number field, typed by the sharer, is the only thing that distinguishes them.
- **The direction is picked by hand** and can be picked wrongly. The check described in section 2 catches it after a few kilometres, pauses that bus, and asks the person to confirm.

TO REPLY, OR TO ASK US TO STOP

One person maintains this and reads everything sent to it.

[jvlandingin@proton.me](mailto:jvlandingin@proton.me)

Source code: [github.com/jvlandingin/community-bus-tracker](https://github.com/jvlandingin/community-bus-tracker)

The tracker itself: [community-bus-tracker.netlify.app](https://community-bus-tracker.netlify.app)

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